Gestures to be avoided to prevent distraction

- **Excessive Gesturing:** Using too many hand movements or flapping arms can distract the audience and take focus away from the message. Gestures should support the speech, not overwhelm it.
- **Fidgeting and Tapping:** Finger tapping, foot tapping, or tapping on furniture can be distracting, especially if it produces noise picked up by microphones.
- **Hands in Pockets:** This can appear unprofessional and convey nervousness or lack of confidence.
- **Crossed Arms:** This closed posture can signal defensiveness or discomfort and may alienate the audience.
- **Blocking the Face:** Covering the mouth, eyes, or face with hands hinders the ability to convey expressions and weakens communication impact.
- **Pointing or Finger Wagging:** These gestures can seem confrontational or aggressive, which may distract or put off the audience.
- **Scratching the Head or Touching the Face:** These can indicate nervousness or insecurity and divert attention from the speaker's message.
- **Adjusting Clothing Repeatedly:** Constantly playing with hair, jewelry, or clothes can be distracting and signal anxiety.
- **Mismatch Between Gestures and Speech:** Gestures that contradict what is being said cause confusion and reduce message clarity.

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